> May that Hari, the Lord of the Three Worlds, give you whatever you desire.

Vijayasena used Jain scriptures to expose the venality of the Brahmins' accusations and proved to Akbar and his courtiers the similarity of Jain thought to the Samkhya philosophy of the Brahmins. Through some sharp verbal calisthenics, the Jains equated the concept of karma to theism and thereby put the argument to rest. Pleased, Akbar gave Vijayasena the title Savai Hiravijaya Suri, i.e. a quarter greater than his master Hiravijaya. 'When the Brahmans were defeated by the Suri,' gloated the Jains, 'they became so emasculated it is amazing the townspeople did not lust after them as if they were women.'

Jain monks remained at the Mughal court continuously till 1605, altering forever the significance of this otherwise insubstantial sect. Siddhichandra's biography of his master Hiravijaya described the virtues of Akbar, in which the Mughal Padshah was firmly welcomed into the Jain worldview:

> There is not a single art, not a single branch of knowledge, not a single act of boldness and strength which was not attempted by young Akbar…thieves and robbers were conspicuous by their absence in his empire…

He further compared him to the son of Kaushaliya (i.e. Ram) and wrote that 'his religious fervour never made him intolerant as is shown by his degree of regard for all the six systems of philosophy. He took interest in all the arts and all branches of learning.'

Akbar remained fascinated by the Jain monks till the end of his reign. The Jain concepts of compassion to all living things would have resonated deeply with Akbar, especially from this time on, as his attention radiated outwards to the dispossessed and the uncounted. He extended his powerful support to this small sect, keeping them safe from attack from other religious groups that were jealous of their meteoric rise. Following requests from the Jain monks Akbar issued farmans prohibiting animal slaughter for twelve days every year, allowed tax exemptions for Jain pilgrims, protected Jain temples in Gujarat besides awarding further donations and gifts. Abu'l Fazl, when listing the great seers of Hindustan, allowed that the Jains 'perceive the mysteries of the external and internal and in their